

SAFEGUARDING STATEMENT: Our Commitment

Sporting Chance Project Ltd (SCP) is committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of children and young people (CYP) and maintaining a safe, supportive, inclusive and anti-discriminatory environment.

In order to protect children and young people (CYP) from maltreatment, abuse, neglect and exploitation, prevent impairment of their mental and physical health or development, ensure that they grow up in circumstances consistent with safe and effective care, and take action to enable them to have the best outcomes, we identify concerns early and respond promptly. Our safeguarding approach is aligned with Keeping Children Safe in Education (KCSIE) 2026, Working Together to Safeguard Children 2026, the Children Acts 1989 and 2004, the Equality Act 2010 and relevant Local Authority arrangements.

KCSIE applies directly to schools and colleges and concerns children under 18. SCP is a non-school Alternative Learning Provider and applies the relevant KCSIE expectations within its own provision and contractual arrangements, while supporting commissioning schools, colleges, Local Authorities and other placing bodies to discharge their responsibilities. SCP does not assume statutory duties or powers that belong specifically to a maintained school, college, governing body or Local Authority.

SCP operates across Bristol City Council, South Gloucestershire Council, Bath & North East Somerset (BANES), and North Somerset, and follows the safeguarding procedures and referral pathways of the relevant Local Authority.

What We Do

- Promote the welfare of all participants, ensuring they have the best possible experience free from harm.
- Recognise that some individuals may face additional barriers to recognising or reporting abuse, or increased vulnerability due to age, disability, SEND, communication needs, learning differences, care experience, family circumstances, protected characteristics or other factors.
- Recognise racism, faith-based prejudice and other discrimination as harm in its own right and promote an inclusive, anti-discriminatory safeguarding culture.
- Remain alert to harm at home, outside the home and online, including child-on-child abuse, sexual abuse, exploitation, domestic abuse, serious violence, radicalisation, bullying, discriminatory harm, AI-generated or deepfake sexual imagery and other emerging risks.
- Expect all staff, volunteers, directors, agency workers, contractors, and partners to follow our safeguarding policies and procedures as appropriate to their roles.
- Work with learners, parents/carers where safe and appropriate, commissioners and statutory agencies, sharing information where necessary, proportionate and lawful.

We adopt a child-centred, trauma-informed and non-blaming approach, ensuring that the voice, needs, lived experience and best interests of the child are at the heart of all decisions. A child may not recognise or disclose abuse, and the absence of a report does not mean that harm is not occurring.

Our Safeguarding Responsibilities

- We have appointed Tony Ricketts as Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL), with Sharon Galton and Jordan Ricketts as Deputy DSLs.
- We maintain robust safeguarding and child protection policies and procedures, which are reviewed at least annually and updated when legislation, guidance, local arrangements or identified risks change. SCP's Child Protection & Safeguarding Policy is the principal and controlling policy.
- Staff receive safeguarding induction, appropriate training and regular updates. All staff are required by SCP to read KCSIE 2026 Part One in full and understand SCP's reporting procedures.
- Adults working with us are subject to safer-recruitment and suitability checks appropriate to their role, including Disclosure and Barring Service checks and barred-list information where the role is legally eligible and requires them.
- We maintain clear procedures for child-on-child abuse; online safety; risk outside the home; attendance and missing learners; Prevent; professional boundaries; low-level concerns; allegations against adults; LADO consultation; whistleblowing; and statutory DBS or professional referrals.
- We act immediately where a child may be at risk of significant harm or in immediate danger and do not delay a referral because information is incomplete, the DSL is unavailable or another organisation may also be responsible.
- We record concerns and decisions accurately and securely and share information in accordance with safeguarding law, UK GDPR, the Data Protection Act 2018 & the Data (Use & Access) Act 2025. Data protection law is not a barrier to necessary safeguarding information sharing.

Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility and requires a culture of vigilance, openness, inclusion, professional curiosity & respectful challenge.

How to Share Concerns

If you have any concern about the safety or wellbeing of a child under 18, including a post-16 learner who is still a child, report it immediately to SCP's Designated Safeguarding Team:

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|---------------------------------|-----------------|--------------|------------------------------------|
| • Designated Safeguarding Lead: | Tony Ricketts | 07748 636711 | tony@sportingchanceproject.co.uk |
| • Deputy Safeguarding Lead: | Sharon Galton | 07712 838042 | sharon@sportingchanceproject.co.uk |
| • Deputy Safeguarding Lead: | Jordan Ricketts | 07920 425407 | jordan@sportingchanceproject.co.uk |

If the DSL is unavailable, contact either Deputy DSL. If none of the safeguarding team can be reached, do not wait: contact the relevant Local Authority Children's Social Care service and/or police directly, and inform the commissioning school, college, Local Authority or other placing body where appropriate. Anyone can make a safeguarding referral. In an emergency or where a child is in immediate danger, call police on 999.

Concerns about an adult learner will be considered under the Care Act 2014 adult-safeguarding threshold where applicable and through the appropriate adult welfare, health or criminal-reporting route. KCSIE child-protection procedures do not automatically apply to a person aged 18 or over.

Current child-concern contacts include:

- Bristol City Council First Response: **0117 903 6444**
- South Gloucestershire Access and Response Team: **01454 866000**
- Bath & North East Somerset Children's Social Work Services: **01225 396111 or 01225 477929**
- North Somerset Children's Front Door: **01275 888808**
- Emergency Duty Team outside normal office hours: **01454 615165**

Contact details and referral methods can change. The relevant Local Authority's official website must be checked when making a referral. A referral must not be delayed if a published route is temporarily unavailable; call 999 where there is immediate danger.

Concerns about the conduct of a member of staff, volunteer, contractor or another adult working for or on behalf of SCP must be reported under SCP's Allegations Against Staff, Low-Level Concerns and LADO Procedure. Where the concern relates to Tony Ricketts, or there is an actual or perceived conflict of interest, do not report it back to him: contact the Local Authority Designated Officer (LADO) for the Local Authority in which the adult works. The Bristol LADO contact is **0117 903 7795 or LADO@bristol.gov.uk**; current routes for all areas must be checked on the relevant Local Authority website. Contact the police and Children's Social Care immediately where required.

All concerns will be taken seriously, recorded appropriately, and responded to promptly in line with safeguarding procedures. A person raising a concern does not need proof and must not investigate the matter themselves or promise confidentiality.

Promoting a Safe Culture

We are committed to embedding a positive, inclusive and proactive safeguarding culture in everything we do.

All staff, volunteers, participants, and their families are encouraged and supported to raise concerns through accessible routes. Action will be taken promptly, fairly, sensitively and with appropriate confidentiality, in line with SCP's Child Protection & Safeguarding Policy, Allegations Against Staff, Low-Level Concerns and LADO Procedure and Whistleblowing Policy.

We promote an environment where individuals feel safe to speak up, where inappropriate or discriminatory behaviour is challenged, and where safeguarding concerns are identified early and addressed effectively. No one will be disadvantaged for raising a genuine concern honestly and on the basis of a reasonable belief, even if it is not substantiated.

Signed: _____ Tony Ricketts

Date: _____

(Director and Designated Safeguarding Lead)

Approval and document control

This policy is approved by the Director of SCP and is subject to annual review or earlier review in response to changes in legislation, statutory guidance, organisational structure or safeguarding practice.

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Author: Nigel Davies
Policy owner: Tony Ricketts, DSL and Director
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